10-22 第二篇

The Diversity of World Languages

Language is one of the most remarkable abilities of the human species. Across the globe, people communicate using approximately 7,000 different languages, each with its own unique sounds, grammar, and vocabulary. This incredible variety reflects the diverse histories, environments, and cultures of human communities. [1] Understanding language diversity helps us appreciate how different peoples have found creative ways to express their thoughts, feelings, and experiences.

Languages differ in fascinating ways. Some languages have dozens of words for snow or rain, reflecting the environment where they developed. Others have complex systems of politeness or unique ways of expressing time and direction. [2] These differences show that language is not just a tool for communication—it is a window into how different cultures understand and organize the world.

Despite this rich diversity, many languages are under threat. As globalization spreads, a few major languages dominate international business, media, and education. [3] Smaller languages struggle to compete, and when children grow up speaking only the dominant language, their parents' language may disappear within a generation.

Efforts to preserve language diversity are growing. Communities, schools, and governments are developing programs to teach and revitalize endangered languages. [4] Digital technology has also become a powerful ally, with apps and online platforms making it possible for people to learn and practice languages that were once at risk of being forgotten.

Language diversity is a treasure that belongs to all of humanity. Just as we protect endangered animals and natural habitats, we should also protect endangered languages. [5] Every language that survives carries with it a unique way of thinking, a unique body of knowledge, and a unique piece of the human story that would otherwise be lost forever.

选项

A. The sheer variety of human languages is a testament to the creativity and adaptability of our species. B. Exploring these linguistic differences reveals the deep connections between language, thought, and culture. C. This linguistic dominance puts thousands of smaller languages at risk of extinction within the coming decades. D. These preservation efforts demonstrate that language loss is not inevitable if communities and institutions take action. E. Protecting linguistic diversity is as important as protecting biodiversity—

both are essential to a healthy, vibrant world. F. For example, the Pirahã language of the Amazon has no words for specific numbers, using only terms like "few" and "many."

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前说约7000种语言反映了人类社区的多样历史与文化，空后说理解语言多样性有助于欣赏不同民族的创造性表达。A的"sheer variety of human languages"承接数量之多，"testament to the creativity and adaptability"概括多样性的意义。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前列举语言间的有趣差异（雪的词汇、礼貌系统等），空后说这些差异表明语言不仅是交流工具。B的"Exploring these linguistic differences"承接前文差异，"deep connections between language, thought, and culture"引出更深层关系。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前说全球化使少数主要语言主导国际领域，空后说小语言难以竞争、可能一代人内消亡。C的"This linguistic dominance"承接主要语言的主导地位，"puts thousands of smaller languages at risk"概括威胁。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：空前列举保护语言多样性的努力（社区、学校、政府项目），空后说数字技术也成为有力工具。D的"These preservation efforts demonstrate"承接保护努力，"language loss is not inevitable"传递希望。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：空前将保护语言与保护濒危动物和栖息地类比，空后说每种存活的语言都承载独特知识和人类故事。E的"Protecting linguistic diversity is as important as protecting biodiversity"承接类比，"essential to a healthy, vibrant world"升华主题。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, the Pirahã language of the Amazon has no words for specific numbers, using only terms like "few" and "many."**：以For example开

头，属具体语言案例；易误放[2]，但[2]需的是语言差异与文化关系的概括，非单一语言案例。